SSC CGL 2024 Tier-I question paper with answers

10 September 2024 · Shift 1

75 questions as the Staff Selection Commission (SSC) printed them · answers from the official key · marking: +2 for a right answer, –0.50 for a wrong one

The other 25 of the paper's 100 questions are not reproduced: they need a figure or are printed as an image, or ask about formatting the source does not keep.

Try every question first: the answer key and the explanations follow the questions. Official answer-key notice: https://ssc.gov.in/api/attachment/uploads/masterData/AnswerKeys/Writeup_Final_Anwerkey_CGLE_2024_T1_191224.pdf

Compare your score: the official 2024 cut-off (Tier-I, all posts except JSO and SI Grade-II), out of 200

UR 153.19 **OBC** 146.26 **EWS** 142.02 **SC** 126.46 **ST** 111.89 **ESM** 69.93 **OH** 113.10 **HH** 64.79 **VH** 102.97 **Other PwD** 45.74

Cut-offs apply to marks normalised across all the exam's shifts, so a raw score on one shift is a rough guide. Source: the official result write-up, https://ssc.gov.in/api/attachment/uploads/masterData/NoticeBoards/Result%20Write-up%20CGLE%202024%20Tier%20I_51224.pdf

General Intelligence and Reasoning 16 questions

Q.1

Read the given statements and conclusions carefully. Assuming that the information given in the statements is true, even if it appears to be at variance with commonly known facts, decide which of the given conclusions logically follow(s) from the statements. Statements: Some boxes are cartons. All cartons are papers. Some cartons are utensils. Conclusion (I): No box is a utensil. Conclusion (II): Some papers are utensils.

(A) Only conclusion (II) follows
(B) Only conclusion (I) follows
(C) Both conclusions (I) and (II) follow
(D) Neither conclusion (I) nor (II) follows

Q.4

In a certain code language, 'BELL' is written as 'MKFA' and 'BOND' is written as 'EMPA'. How will 'BLEW' be written in that language?

(A) XDMA
(B) XMDA
(C) XMAD
(D) XDAM

Q.5

Four letter-clusters have been given, out of which three are alike in some manner and one is different. Select the one that is different. The odd one out is not based on the number of consonants/vowels or their position in the letter cluster

(A) AFK
(B) LQV
(C) PTX
(D) DIN

Q.6

10 is related to 15 following certain logic. Following the same logic, 42 is related to 63. To which of the following numbers is 22 related, following the same logic? (NOTE : Operations should be performed on the whole numbers, without breaking down the numbers into its constituent digits. E.g. 13 – Operations on 13 such as adding /deleting /multiplying etc., to 13 can be performed. Breaking down 13 into 1 and 3 and then performing mathematical operations on 1 and 3 is not allowed.)

(A) 31
(B) 33
(C) 28
(D) 30

Q.8

In a certain code language, ‘sit on chair’ is coded as 'sk mi cn' and ‘the chair broke’ is coded as ‘gm fr mi’. How is ‘chair’ coded in the given language?

(A) gm
(B) sk
(C) mi
(D) cn

Q.9

Select the set in which the numbers are related in the same way as are the numbers of the following set. (79, 58, 62) (54, 33, 37) (NOTE: Operations should be performed on the whole numbers, without breaking down the numbers into its constituent digits. E.g. 13 – Operations on 13 such as adding/deleting/multiplying etc. to 13 can be performed. Breaking down 13 into 1 and 3 and then performing mathematical operations on 1 and 3 is not allowed.)

(A) (59, 33, 43)
(B) (66, 45, 49)
(C) (47, 36, 41)
(D) (43, 25, 30)

Q.10

Three of the following four options are alike in a certain way and thus form a group. Which is the option that does NOT belong to that group? (NOTE : Operations should be performed on the whole numbers, without breaking down the numbers into its constituent digits. E.g. 13 – Operations on 13 such as adding /deleting /multiplying etc., to 13 can be performed. Breaking down 13 into 1 and 3 and then performing mathematical operations on 1 and 3 is not allowed).

(A) 2 – 2 – 4
(B) 1 – 3 – 3
(C) 2 – 4 – 8
(D) 3 – 2 – 5

Q.13

Select the option that can replace the question mark (?) in the following series. FM61, EK58, DI55, CG52, ?

(A) BE49
(B) CD44
(C) BF48
(D) CE46

Q.15

Select the set in which the numbers are related in the same way as are the numbers of the following set. (7, 9, 48) (6, 8, 42) (NOTE: Operations should be performed on the whole numbers, without breaking down the numbers into its constituent digits. E.g. 13 – Operations on 13 such as adding/deleting/multiplying etc. to 13 can be performed. Breaking down 13 into 1 and 3 and then performing mathematical operations on 1 and 3 is not allowed.)

(A) (10, 12, 54)
(B) (9, 11, 56)
(C) (11, 13, 72)
(D) (8, 10, 47)

Q.16

Which two signs should be interchanged to make the following equation correct? 18 – 23 × 455 ÷ 7 + 28 = 377

(A) ÷ and –
(B) – and +
(C) + and ×
(D) – and ×

Q.17

Select the option that represents the letters that when placed from left to right in the blanks below will complete the given letter series. L M B A _ H O L M B A C _ O L M _ A C H O L _ B A C H O L _

(A) CHMBM
(B) CMHBM
(C) CHBMM
(D) CHMMB

Q.18
The position of how many letters will remain unchanged if each of the letters in the word 'PRANKED' is arranged in the English alphabetical order?

(A) One
(B) None
(C) Three
(D) Two

Q.19
In a certain code language, A # B means A is the sister of B. A @ B means A is the son of B. A & B means A is the wife of B. A % B means A is the father of B. How is Q related to R if P & Q % L # R & K?

(A) Sister
(B) Mother
(C) Father
(D) Wife

Q.20
What will come in place of the question mark (?) in the following equation if '+' and '÷' are interchanged and '×' and '–' are interchanged? 4 – 12 + 3 ÷ 12 × 6 = ?

(A) 11
(B) 46
(C) 13
(D) 22

Q.22
Which letter-cluster will replace the question mark (?) to complete the given series? ZVRN, VSPM, RPNL, ?, JJJJ

(A) RNLL
(B) NMLK
(C) RMLN
(D) RNLK

Q.24
Select the number from among the given options that can replace the question mark (?) in the following series. 23, 27, 43, 79, 143, ?

(A) 240
(B) 243
(C) 200
(D) 250

General Awareness 25 questions

Q.1
Which government honoured a distinguished percussionist named Pandit Anindo Chatterjee with the Banga Vibhushan Award in 2022?

(A) Jharkhand
(B) West Bengal
(C) Tripura
(D) Assam

Q.2
According to the Indian Railways (2019-2020), which state has the largest railway track in India?

(A) Madhya Pradesh
(B) Uttar Pradesh
(C) Haryana
(D) Punjab

Q.3
Who was appointed as India's 28th Controller General of Accounts (CGA) in March 2023?

(A) Praveen Sharma
(B) SS Dubey
(C) Vikram Devdutt
(D) Arun Goel

Q.4
After the death of Humayun, the 13 year-old Akbar was coronated in 1556 at Kalanaur in _____.

(A) Gujarat
(B) Rajasthan
(C) Punjab
(D) Bengal

Q.5
Which Five-Year Plan primarily focused on the 'Garibi Hatao' initiative?

(A) Fourth Five-Year Plan
(B) Sixth Five-Year Plan
(C) Third Five-Year Plan
(D) Fifth Five-Year Plan

Q.6
In which of the following cities of Manipur is the Jawaharlal Nehru Manipur Dance Academy located?

(A) Ukhrul
(B) Imphal
(C) Chandel
(D) Thoubal

Q.7
Which Governor-General of British India helped Raja Ram Mohan Roy legally abolish the sati practice?

(A) Lord Curzon
(B) Lord William Bentinck
(C) Lord Cornwallis
(D) Lord Ripon

Q.8
Mahabalipuram emerged as an important centre of temple architecture under which of the following kingdoms of south India?

(A) Pallava
(B) Chera
(C) Chola
(D) Chalukya

Q.9
Which of the following was the mascot of the FIH men's Hockey World Cup – 2023?

(A) Asha
(B) Bheema
(C) Jitu
(D) Olly

Q.10
By which of the following state governments is the Tansen Music Festival organised?

(A) Madhya Pradesh Government
(B) Maharashtra Government
(C) Uttar Pradesh Government
(D) Rajasthan Government

Q.11
Which of the following statements is INCORRECT about the Directive Principles of State Policy?

(A) They are positive, as they require the State to do certain things.
(B) These have moral and political sanctions.
(C) They aim at establishing social and economic democracy in the country.
(D) They promote welfare of individuals. Hence, they are personal and individualistic.

Q.12
The Indian Constitution has established _____.

(A) independent judicial system
(B) plural judicial system
(C) dual judicial system
(D) partial Judicial system

Q.13
Which of the following is a non-perishable food?

(A) Pulses
(B) Curds
(C) Meat
(D) Milk

Q.14

Which of the following is NOT correct with regards to the history of calculating National Income (NI) in India?

(A) Dadabhai Naoroji divided the Indian economy into two parts: primary sector and secondary sector.

(B) First attempt to compute NI was made by Dadabhai Naoroji.

(C) First official attempt to compute NI was made by PC Mahalanobis.

(D) First scientific method to compute NI was used by Dr VKRV Rao.

Q.15

Hubbardia heptaneuron, which has become endangered, is a species of which of the following?

(A) Tiger

(B) Bamboo

(C) Crane

(D) Grass

Q.16

The Parliament passed the Marine Aids to Navigation Bill, 2021 to repeal and replace which of the following Acts?

(A) The Dourine Act, 1910

(B) The Lighthouse Act, 1927

(C) The Dangerous Machines (Regulation) Act, 1983

(D) The Personal Injuries (Emergency Provisions) Act, 1962

Q.17

When was the 1st Asian Kabaddi Championship held?

(A) 1975

(B) 1970

(C) 1980

(D) 1985

Q.18

The climate of a place is NOT affected by which of the following?

(A) Location

(B) Type of soil

(C) Relief

(D) Distance from the sea

Q.19

In which musical note did Newland put the metals Co and Ni with halogens?

(A) Re

(B) Mi

(C) Do

(D) Fa

Q.20

Which of the following places is related to Gandhi's Satyagraha of the year 1917?

(A) Champaran

(B) Ahmedabad

(C) Kheda

(D) Bardoli

Q.21

Which of the following is in geographical proximity to Sri Lanka?

(A) Only Karaikal

(B) Karaikal and Yanam

(C) Only Yanam

(D) Mahe

Q.22

The decomposition of gaseous Ammonia on a hot platinum surface is a _____ order reaction at high pressure.

(A) three

(B) two

(C) zero

(D) one

Q.23
Which organisms are classified as Aves?

(A) Frogs
(B) Snakes
(C) Birds
(D) Fishes

Q.24
Which of the following festivals is celebrated as the birth anniversary of Guru Nanak Dev?

(A) Hola Mohalla
(B) Baisakhi
(C) Gurpurab
(D) Chappar Mela

Q.25
How many awards were presented at the National Sports and Adventure Awards-2022 ceremony held at Rashtrapati Bhavan on 30 November 2022?

(A) 44
(B) 52
(C) 28
(D) 32

Quantitative Aptitude 10 questions

Q.2
Kiran lent ₹4,000 to two persons such that one part of it at the rate of 8% per annum and the remaining part at the rate of 10% per annum. He got an annual simple interest of ₹352. Then the sum lent at 10% is:

(A) ₹2,400
(B) ₹1,800
(C) ₹1,600
(D) ₹2,200

Q.3
By applying which of the following criteria can two triangles NOT be proved congruent?

(A) side-side-side
(B) angle-angle-angle
(C) side-angle-side
(D) angle-side-angle

Q.5
X, Y, and Z are three points on a plane with XY = 11 cm, YZ = 13 cm, and XZ = 24 cm. The number of circles that travel through points X, Y, and Z is:

(A) 0
(B) 2
(C) 1
(D) 3

Q.6
Which of the following is the largest 5-digit number divisible by 47?

(A) 99999
(B) 10000
(C) 99969
(D) 98888

Q.7
If, on a marked price, the difference between selling prices with a discount of 65% and with two successive discounts of 30% and 40% is ₹105, then the marked price (in ₹) is:

(A) 1,500
(B) 1,050
(C) 1,650
(D) 1,320

Q.10
Three pipes P, Q and R can fill a cistern in 40 minutes, 80 minutes and 120 minutes, respectively. Initially, all the pipes are opened. After how much time (in minutes) should the pipes Q and R be turned off so that the cistern will be completely filled in just half an hour?

(A) 12
(B) 16
(C) 14
(D) 10

Q.11

The ages of two friends, Ram and Ravi, differ by 7 years. Ram's mother Mayadevi is three times as old as Ram, and Ravi is four times as old as his brother Soham. The ages of Mayadevi and Soham differ by 65 years. Find the age of Mayadevi (in years).

(A) 45
(B) 69
(C) 36
(D) 85

Q.13

A money bag contains one rupee, 5 rupee and 10 rupee coins in the ratio of 3 : 5 : 7 respectively. If the total amount in the bag is ₹980, then find the number of coins of ₹10.

(A) 71
(B) 68
(C) 69
(D) 70

Q.22

If the sum of three numbers is 18 and the sum of their squares is 36, then find the difference between the sum of their cubes and three times of their product.

(A) 1449
(B) –1494
(C) 4149
(D) –1944

Q.24

In a circular race of 750 m, X and Y start from the same point and at the same time with speeds of 9 km/h and 13.5 km/h, respectively. If they are running in the same direction then, when will they meet again for the first time on the track?

(A) 500 seconds
(B) 600 seconds
(C) 900 seconds
(D) 750 seconds

English Comprehension 24 questions

Q.1

Select the most appropriate synonym of the underlined word in the given sentence. The Morbi bridge mishap has left Gujarat in a "deplorable" state.

(A) Complaining
(B) Despicable
(C) Rejoicing
(D) Jubilation

Q.2

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words. A government by the officials

(A) Monarchy
(B) Autocracy
(C) Bureaucracy
(D) Plutocracy

Q.3

Select the most appropriate idiom to fill in the blank. I'm _____ about whether to accept the job offer or continue freelancing. Both options have their advantages.

(A) up in arms
(B) left out in cold
(C) on the fence
(D) cutting corners

Q.4

The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error. After the concert was over, / they go to a restaurant, / had dinner together / and talked until midnight.

(A) they go to a restaurant,
(B) had dinner together
(C) and talked until midnight
(D) After the concert was over,

Q.5

Select the most appropriate synonym of the underlined word. He was “trembling” with fear.

(A) Intrepid
(B) Weeping
(C) Running
(D) Shivering

Q.6

Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. I have been living in Hyderabad “since I am born” .

(A) since I was born
(B) since I have born
(C) since I will be born
(D) since I born

Q.7

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words. A person who sells and arranges cut flowers.

(A) Horticulturist
(B) Botanist
(C) Florist
(D) Gardener

Q.8

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the underlined word. She was “elated” about her promotion, but her colleague felt quite disheartened.

(A) proud
(B) delighted
(C) cheerful
(D) discouraged

Q.9

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words. A place where fruit trees are grown

(A) Garden
(B) Museum
(C) Quay
(D) Orchard

Q.10

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words. A small group of people who spend their time together and do not welcome other people into that group

(A) Clique
(B) Employees
(C) Lobby
(D) Squad

Q.11

The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error. Renewable energy / sources like solar and wind power / will replaced traditional fossil fuels / and help reduce carbon emissions.

(A) and help reduce carbon emissions
(B) will replaced traditional fossil fuels
(C) sources like solar and wind power
(D) Renewable energy

Q.12

Sentences of a paragraph are given below in jumbled order. Arrange the sentences in the correct order to form a meaningful and coherent paragraph. A. More children go to school than at any time in the past. But more children today are out of school than any time in the past. B. But it is not enough to blame the high birth rate for this state of affairs. C. Indeed, it can be reasonably argued that continued mass illiteracy is not the result but the cause of the high birth rate. D. There are more literate people in India today than ever before. But there are also more illiterates than ever before.

(A) ABCD
(B) DABC
(C) CBAD
(D) BADC

Q.13

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. On the ball

(A) Aware of any changes or developments and quick to react to them

(B) Unaware of any changes or developments and lazy to react to them

(C) Aware of any changes or developments but slow to react to them

(D) Aware of any changes or developments but doing nothing

Q.15

Identify the most appropriate antonym of the given word. Timid

(A) Meek

(B) Daring

(C) Spooky

(D) Anxious

Q.16

Select the option that expresses the given sentence in active voice. The contract was grabbed by the biggest telecom company in India.

(A) The biggest telecom company in India grabs the contract.

(B) The biggest telecom company in India grabbed the contract.

(C) The biggest telecom company in India will grab the contract.

(D) The biggest telecom company in India has grabbed the contract.

Q.17

The following sentence contains a word with a spelling error. Rectify the sentence by selecting the correct spelling of the identified word from the given options. He has to be conscious of his public manners as he is a decendent of a reputed family in this region.

(A) Dicsendent

(B) Decendant

(C) Descendant

(D) Discendent

Q.18

Select the option that expresses the given sentence in active voice. By whom was grammar taught to you?

(A) You were taught grammar by whom?

(B) Who taught you grammar?

(C) Who had taught you grammar?

(D) Did he teach you grammar?

Q.19

Identify from the given options the word which is similar in meaning to the following word. Equivocal

(A) Ambiguous

(B) Balanced

(C) Clear

(D) Representative

Q.20

Select the correctly spelt word.

(A) Collaegue

(B) Conscensus

(C) Entrepreneurship

(D) Bizzaire

Q.21

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. The third National Wildlife Action Plan for 2017- 2031, underlying India's plan for wildlife conservation, was unveiled (1)_____ the Global Wildlife Programme conference. The plan recognises (2)_____ addresses concerns pertaining to climate changes and its impact on wildlife . The plan details the importance of ecosystems for food production, health and other aspects of (3)_____ survival and sustainable development. It also emphasises preservation of genetic (4)_____ and sustainable utilisation of species and ecosystems which has direct bearing on our scientific advancements and support to millions of rural communities. The plan underscores rehabilitation of threatened wildlife species (5)_____ inland aquatic, coastal and marine ecosystems while conserving their habitats.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 1.

(A) for
(B) at
(C) to
(D) in

Q.22

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. The third National Wildlife Action Plan for 2017- 2031, underlying India's plan for wildlife conservation, was unveiled (1)_____ the Global Wildlife Programme conference. The plan recognises (2)_____ addresses concerns pertaining to climate changes and its impact on wildlife . The plan details the importance of ecosystems for food production, health and other aspects of (3)_____ survival and sustainable development. It also emphasises preservation of genetic (4)_____ and sustainable utilisation of species and ecosystems which has direct bearing on our scientific advancements and support to millions of rural communities. The plan underscores rehabilitation of threatened wildlife species (5)_____ inland aquatic, coastal and marine ecosystems while conserving their habitats.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 2.

(A) in
(B) to
(C) and
(D) for

Q.23

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. The third National Wildlife Action Plan for 2017- 2031, underlying India's plan for wildlife conservation, was unveiled (1)_____ the Global Wildlife Programme conference. The plan recognises (2)_____ addresses concerns pertaining to climate changes and its impact on wildlife . The plan details the importance of ecosystems for food production, health and other aspects of (3)_____ survival and sustainable development. It also emphasises preservation of genetic (4)_____ and sustainable utilisation of species and ecosystems which has direct bearing on our scientific advancements and support to millions of rural communities. The plan underscores rehabilitation of threatened wildlife species (5)_____ inland aquatic, coastal and marine ecosystems while conserving their habitats.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 3.

(A) breed
(B) species
(C) group
(D) human

Q.24

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. The third National Wildlife Action Plan for 2017- 2031, underlying India's plan for wildlife conservation, was unveiled (1)_____ the Global Wildlife Programme conference. The plan recognises (2)_____ addresses concerns pertaining to climate changes and its impact on wildlife . The plan details the importance of ecosystems for food production, health and other aspects of (3)_____ survival and sustainable development. It also emphasises preservation of genetic (4)_____ and sustainable utilisation of species and ecosystems which has direct bearing on our scientific advancements and support to millions of rural communities. The plan underscores rehabilitation of threatened wildlife species (5)_____ inland aquatic, coastal and marine ecosystems while conserving their habitats.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 4.

(A) conflict

(B) rejection

(C) focus

(D) diversity

Q.25

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. The third National Wildlife Action Plan for 2017- 2031, underlying India's plan for wildlife conservation, was unveiled (1)_____ the Global Wildlife Programme conference. The plan recognises (2)_____ addresses concerns pertaining to climate changes and its impact on wildlife . The plan details the importance of ecosystems for food production, health and other aspects of (3)_____ survival and sustainable development. It also emphasises preservation of genetic (4)_____ and sustainable utilisation of species and ecosystems which has direct bearing on our scientific advancements and support to millions of rural communities. The plan underscores rehabilitation of threatened wildlife species (5)_____ inland aquatic, coastal and marine ecosystems while conserving their habitats.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 5.

(A) including

(B) mixing

(C) gathering

(D) counting

Answer key

General Intelligence and Reasoning

Q.1 **(A)**	Q.4 **(A)**	Q.5 **(C)**	Q.6 **(B)**	Q.8 **(C)**	Q.9 **(B)**
Q.10 **(D)**	Q.13 **(A)**	Q.15 **(C)**	Q.16 **(D)**	Q.17 **(C)**	Q.18 **(B)**
Q.19 **(C)**	Q.20 **(D)**	Q.22 **(B)**	Q.24 **(B)**		

General Awareness

Q.1 **(B)**	Q.2 **(B)**	Q.3 **(B)**	Q.4 **(C)**	Q.5 **(D)**	Q.6 **(B)**
Q.7 **(B)**	Q.8 **(A)**	Q.9 **(D)**	Q.10 **(A)**	Q.11 **(D)**	Q.12 **(A)**
Q.13 **(A)**	Q.14 **(A)**	Q.15 **(D)**	Q.16 **(B)**	Q.17 **(C)**	Q.18 **(B)**
Q.19 **(C)**	Q.20 **(A)**	Q.21 **(A)**	Q.22 **(C)**	Q.23 **(C)**	Q.24 **(C)**
Q.25 **(A)**					

Quantitative Aptitude

Q.2 **(C)**	Q.3 **(B)**	Q.5 **(A)**	Q.6 **(C)**	Q.7 **(A)**	Q.10 **(A)**
Q.11 **(B)**	Q.13 **(D)**	Q.22 **(D)**	Q.24 **(B)**		

English Comprehension

Q.1 **(B)**	Q.2 **(C)**	Q.3 **(C)**	Q.4 **(A)**	Q.5 **(D)**	Q.6 **(A)**
Q.7 **(C)**	Q.8 **(D)**	Q.9 **(D)**	Q.10 **(A)**	Q.11 **(B)**	Q.12 **(B)**
Q.13 **(A)**	Q.15 **(B)**	Q.16 **(B)**	Q.17 **(C)**	Q.18 **(B)**	Q.19 **(A)**
Q.20 **(C)**	Q.21 **(B)**	Q.22 **(C)**	Q.23 **(D)**	Q.24 **(D)**	Q.25 **(A)**

Explanations

General Intelligence and Reasoning

Q.1 · Answer (A) Only conclusion (II) follows

Some cartons are utensils and all cartons are papers, so some papers are utensils (II). Some boxes are cartons, but nothing rules out a box being a utensil, so I does not follow.

Q.4 · Answer (A) XDMA

Each word is written in reverse, then its letters move +1, −1, +1, −1: BELL → LLEB → MKFA and BOND → DNOB → EMPA. So BLEW → WELB → XDMA.

Q.5 · Answer (C) PTX

In AFK, LQV and DIN each letter is 5 places after the one before it. In PTX the steps are 4, so it is the odd one.

Q.6 · Answer (B) 33

Each number is related to 1.5 times itself: 10 → 15 and 42 → 63. So 22 → 33.

Q.8 · Answer (C) mi

'chair' is the only word in both sentences and 'mi' the only code in both, so chair = mi.

Q.9 · Answer (B) (66, 45, 49)

In each set the second number is the first minus 21 and the third is the second plus 4: 79 → 58 → 62 and 54 → 33 → 37. Likewise 66 → 45 → 49.

Q.10 · Answer (D) 3 – 2 – 5

In 2 – 2 – 4, 1 – 3 – 3 and 2 – 4 – 8 the third number is the product of the first two. In 3 – 2 – 5 it is their sum (3 × 2 = 6), so it does not belong.

Q.13 · Answer (A) BE49

First letters run F, E, D, C, so next is B; second letters move back two (M, K, I, G), so next is E; the number falls by 3 (61, 58, 55, 52), so next is 49: BE49.

Q.15 · Answer (C) (11, 13, 72)

The third number is three times the sum of the first two: (7 + 9) × 3 = 48 and (6 + 8) × 3 = 42. Likewise (11 + 13) × 3 = 72.

Q.16 · Answer (D) – and ×

Interchanging – and ×: 18 × 23 – 455 ÷ 7 + 28 = 414 – 65 + 28 = 377.

Q.17 · Answer (C) CHBMM

With C, H, B, M, M in the blanks the block LMBACHO repeats: LMBACHO LMBACHO LMBACHO LMBACHO LM.

Q.18 · Answer (B) None

PRANKED in alphabetical order is A D E K N P R. Position by position no letter stays where it was.

Q.19 · Answer (C) Father

P is the wife of Q, Q is the father of L, L is the sister of R and R is the wife of K. L and R are both Q's children, so Q is R's father.

Q.20 · Answer (D) 22

After interchanging the signs: 4 × 12 ÷ 3 + 12 − 6 = 16 + 12 − 6 = 22.

Q.22 · Answer (B) NMLK

Letter by letter the clusters move back by fixed steps: first letters −4 (Z, V, R, N, J), second −3 (V, S, P, M, J), third −2 (R, P, N, L, J) and fourth −1 (N, M, L, K, J). The missing cluster is NMLK.

Q.24 · Answer (B) 243

The differences are 4, 16, 36 and 64, the squares of 2, 4, 6 and 8. Next is $10^2 = 100$: 143 + 100 = 243.

General Awareness

Q.1 · Answer (B) West Bengal

In 2022 the West Bengal government gave its Banga Vibhushan award to tabla player Pandit Anindo Chatterjee.

Q.2 · Answer (B) Uttar Pradesh

Uttar Pradesh has the longest railway network of any state.

Q.3 · Answer (B) SS Dubey

S. S. Dubey took charge as the 28th Controller General of Accounts in March 2023.

Q.4 · Answer (C) Punjab

Akbar was crowned in 1556 at Kalanaur, in the Gurdaspur district of Punjab.

Q.5 · Answer (D) Fifth Five-Year Plan

The Fifth Five-Year Plan (1974-79) put the removal of poverty ('Garibi Hatao') and self-reliance at its centre.

Q.6 · Answer (B) Imphal

The Jawaharlal Nehru Manipur Dance Academy, a unit of the Sangeet Natak Akademi, is in Imphal.

Q.7 · Answer (B) Lord William Bentinck

Lord William Bentinck's Bengal Sati Regulation of 1829 made sati illegal, after Raja Ram Mohan Roy's campaign against it.

Q.8 · Answer (A) Pallava

The Pallava kings, notably Narasimhavarman I and Rajasimha, built Mahabalipuram's rock-cut rathas and the Shore Temple.

Q.9 · Answer (D) Olly

The mascot of the 2023 FIH Men's Hockey World Cup, held in Bhubaneswar and Rourkela, Odisha, was 'Olly'.

Q.10 · Answer (A) Madhya Pradesh Government

The Tansen Samaroh, held every year at Gwalior near Tansen's tomb, is organised by the Madhya Pradesh government.

Q.11 · Answer (D) They promote welfare of individuals. Hence, they are personal and individualistic.

Directive Principles aim at the welfare of the community as a whole; it is the Fundamental Rights that are individualistic. So the last statement is incorrect.

Q.12 · Answer (A) independent judicial system

The Constitution sets up a single, integrated judiciary that is independent of the executive and the legislature; unlike the USA, India has no separate federal and state court systems.

Q.13 · Answer (A) Pulses

Dry pulses keep for months without spoiling; curd, meat and milk spoil within days.

Q.14 · Answer (A) Dadabhai Naoroji divided the Indian economy into two parts: primary sector and secondary sector.

The other three are the standard facts: Naoroji made the first estimate of national income (1867-68), V. K. R. V. Rao first used a scientific method, and the National Income Committee under P. C. Mahalanobis made the first official estimate. SSC's key marks the statement about Naoroji's two-sector division as the incorrect one.

Q.15 · Answer (D) Grass

Hubbardia heptaneuron is an endangered grass of the Western Ghats, known from the spray zone of the Jog Falls in Karnataka.

Q.16 · Answer (B) The Lighthouse Act, 1927

The Marine Aids to Navigation Act, 2021 replaced the nearly century-old Lighthouse Act, 1927.

Q.17 · Answer (C) 1980
The first Asian Kabaddi Championship was held in 1980 in Kolkata (then Calcutta).

Q.18 · Answer (B) Type of soil
Climate depends on location (latitude), relief and altitude, and distance from the sea; the type of soil does not affect it.

Q.19 · Answer (C) Do
In Newlands' table of octaves, cobalt and nickel share a place in the 'Do' column with the halogens fluorine, chlorine and bromine, one of the table's anomalies.

Q.20 · Answer (A) Champaran
Gandhi's first satyagraha in India was at Champaran, Bihar, in 1917, for the indigo farmers. Kheda and the Ahmedabad mill strike came in 1918, Bardoli in 1928.

Q.21 · Answer (A) Only Karaikal
Karaikal, a part of Puducherry on the Tamil Nadu coast, is the closest to Sri Lanka; Yanam is in Andhra Pradesh and Mahe in Kerala.

Q.22 · Answer (C) zero
At high pressure the platinum surface is saturated with ammonia, so the rate does not depend on its concentration: a zero-order reaction.

Q.23 · Answer (C) Birds
Aves is the class of birds.

Q.24 · Answer (C) Gurpurab
Gurpurab (Guru Nanak Jayanti), on Kartik Purnima, marks the birth anniversary of Guru Nanak Dev.

Q.25 · Answer (A) 44
44 awards were presented, including the Major Dhyan Chand Khel Ratna to table tennis player Sharath Kamal and 25 Arjuna Awards.

Quantitative Aptitude

Q.2 · Answer (C) ₹1,600
Let ₹x be lent at 8%. 0.08x + 0.10(4,000 − x) = 352, so 400 − 0.02x = 352 and x = 2,400. The sum at 10% is ₹1,600.

Q.3 · Answer (B) angle-angle-angle
Two triangles with equal angles (AAA) are similar but can differ in size, so AAA does not prove congruence.

Q.5 · Answer (A) 0
XY + YZ = 11 + 13 = 24 = XZ, so Y lies on the segment XZ: the three points are collinear, and no circle passes through three collinear points.

Q.6 · Answer (C) 99969
99999 ÷ 47 leaves remainder 30 (47 × 2127 = 99969), so the largest 5-digit multiple of 47 is 99999 − 30 = 99969.

Q.7 · Answer (A) 1,500
One 65% discount leaves 35% of the marked price; 30% then 40% leaves 0.7 × 0.6 = 42%. The difference, 7% of the marked price, is ₹105, so the marked price is ₹1,500.

Q.10 · Answer (A) 12
P alone fills 30/40 = 3/4 of the cistern in 30 minutes. Q and R must fill the other 1/4 at 1/80 + 1/120 = 1/48 a minute, which takes 12 minutes.

Q.11 · Answer (B) 69
Let Soham be s: Ravi = 4s, Mayadevi = s + 65 and Ram = (s + 65)/3. Ram − Ravi = 7 gives (s + 65)/3 − 4s = 7, so s = 4 and Mayadevi is 69 (Ram 23, Ravi 16).

Q.13 · Answer (D) 70
One set of 3 + 5 + 7 coins is worth 3 × 1 + 5 × 5 + 7 × 10 = ₹98. ₹980 is 10 such sets, so there are 7 × 10 = 70 coins of ₹10.

Q.22 · Answer (D) −1944
$a^3 + b^3 + c^3 - 3abc = (a + b + c)(a^2 + b^2 + c^2 - ab - bc - ca)$. Here ab + bc + ca = $(18^2 - 36)/2 = 144$, so the value is 18 × (36 − 144) = −1944.

Q.24 · Answer (B) 600 seconds
The faster runner gains 13.5 − 9 = 4.5 km/h = 1.25 m/s. Gaining one full lap of 750 m takes 750/1.25 = 600 seconds.

English Comprehension

Q.1 · Answer (B) Despicable
'Deplorable' means shockingly bad. Of the options only 'despicable' is close; 'rejoicing' and 'jubilation' point the other way.

Q.2 · Answer (C) Bureaucracy
Bureaucracy is government by officials who are not elected.

Q.3 · Answer (C) on the fence
To be 'on the fence' is to be undecided between two choices.

Q.4 · Answer (A) they go to a restaurant,
The other verbs are in the past ('was over', 'had', 'talked'), so 'they went to a restaurant'.

Q.5 · Answer (D) Shivering
'Trembling' means shaking: 'shivering'.

Q.6 · Answer (A) since I was born
Birth is a finished past event, so 'since I was born'.

Q.7 · Answer (C) Florist
A florist sells and arranges cut flowers.

Q.8 · Answer (D) discouraged
'Elated' means very happy; its opposite is 'discouraged'.

Q.9 · Answer (D) Orchard
An orchard is land where fruit trees are grown.

Q.10 · Answer (A) Clique
A clique is a small, close group that keeps others out.

Q.11 · Answer (B) will replaced traditional fossil fuels
After 'will' the verb takes its base form: 'will replace'.

Q.12 · Answer (B) DABC
D opens with literacy in India, A extends the same pattern to schooling, B says the high birth rate alone cannot be blamed, and C ('Indeed') takes that point further: DABC.

Q.13 · Answer (A) Aware of any changes or developments and quick to react to them
To be 'on the ball' is to be alert to what is happening and quick to react.

Q.15 · Answer (B) Daring
'Timid' means shy and easily frightened; its opposite is 'daring'.

Q.16 · Answer (B) The biggest telecom company in India grabbed the contract.
'Was grabbed by' is simple past passive, so the active is 'The biggest telecom company in India grabbed the contract.'

Q.17 · Answer (C) Descendant
The correct spelling is 'descendant'.

Q.18 · Answer (B) Who taught you grammar?
'By whom was grammar taught to you?' is the passive of 'Who taught you grammar?'

Q.19 · Answer (A) Ambiguous
'Equivocal' means open to more than one interpretation: 'ambiguous'.

Q.20 · Answer (C) Entrepreneurship
'Entrepreneurship' is spelt correctly; the others should be 'colleague', 'consensus' and 'bizarre'.

Q.21 · Answer (B) at
A plan is unveiled 'at' a conference.

Q.22 · Answer (C) and
'Recognises and addresses': the two verbs share the object 'concerns', so they are joined by 'and'.

Q.23 · Answer (D) human
Ecosystems matter for 'human survival'; the other options do not fit before 'survival'.

Q.24 · Answer (D) diversity
'Genetic diversity' is the standard term for the variety of genes within and between species.

Q.25 · Answer (A) including
The plan covers threatened species 'including' those of inland aquatic, coastal and marine ecosystems.

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